

RUI TAN

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RESEARCH PROFILE

Economics PhD from the University of Liverpool, specialising in tourism economics, service quality, and data-driven hospitality and tourism management. Research focuses on service quality and service performance in tourism and hospitality contexts, alongside tourism policy evaluation, sustainable tourism development, and consumer behaviour. Methodological expertise includes panel-data econometrics, causal inference, efficiency analysis, and large-language-model-based text analysis.

EDUCATION

PhD in Economics, University of Liverpool, UK, Full Scholarship (USD 58,500) 2021–2026
Award approved in March 2026
Thesis: From Cities to Countryside: A Comprehensive Study of Tourism Eco-Efficiency and Rural Tourism Policy Impacts in China.

MSc in Finance, Heilongjiang University, China, First-Class Honours 2017–2020

BSc in Finance, Heilongjiang University, China, First-Class Honours 2013–2017

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Service Quality; Tourism Economics; Data-driven Hospitality and Tourism Management; Smart Tourism and AI Applications in Hospitality and Tourism; Tourism Policy Evaluation; Consumer Behaviour and Service Evaluation; Sustainable Tourism Development.

RESEARCH PUBLICATIONS

Tan, R., Li, Y., Zhang, L., & Luo, Y. Does rural tourism policy unlock economic growth in China's rural areas? A synthetic control approach. *Tourism Economics*. <https://doi.org/10.1177/13548166251403109>. (ABDC A; JCR Q1) 2025

Peypoch, N., Song, Y., **Tan, R.**, & Zhang, L. Tourism efficiency and quality of life in Chinese cities. *International Journal of Tourism Cities*, 10(4), 1304–1317. <https://doi.org/10.1108/IJTC-01-2024-0038>. 2024

WORKING PAPERS AND RESEARCH PIPELINE

Tan, R., Botti, L., & Zhang, L. (2026). **Compensatory and non-compensatory evaluation in restaurants: Evidence from sentiment analysis of online reviews.** Uses large-scale online review data and AI-assisted text analysis to examine compensatory and non-compensatory mechanisms in consumer evaluation, with implications for service-market competition, consumer behaviour, and digital platform economies. 2026

Tan, R., Zhang, L., & Luo, Y. (2026). **Evaluating tourism eco-efficiency in Chinese cities: A slack-based DEA meta-frontier approach.** Measures tourism environmental productivity and efficiency in Chinese cities using a super-efficiency SBM-DEA model, undesirable outputs, and a meta-frontier Malmquist index, with implications for sustainable regional development and environmental policy. 2026

CONFERENCES

Compensatory and Non-Compensatory Evaluation in Restaurants: Evidence from Sentiment Analysis of Online Reviews, The 3rd IERC in Hospitality and Tourism, Macau University of Science and Technology, Macau, China. 2026

Does Rural Tourism Policy Unlock Economic Growth in China's Rural Areas? A Synthetic Control Approach, 8th QATEM Workshop: Quantitative Approaches in Tourism Economics, Henan Normal University, China. 2025

Rural Tourism Policy on Rural Economic Development: A Synthetic Control Model, 11th Conference on Asia and Pacific Economies, Xi'an Jiaotong-Liverpool University, China. 2024

Eco-Efficiency Analysis in Tourism Studies: A Meta-Regression Analysis, Bringing Hospitality, Tourism, Transport and Events Back for Good – The Surrey 2023 Conference, University of Surrey, UK. 2023

RESEARCH PROJECTS

- Co-Principal Investigator and Primary Supervisor**, Do We Travel to Like-Minded Places? How Shared Ideals Shape Tourism Decisions; led and supervised undergraduate students under the SURF programme (SURF-2025-0073), Department of Economics, International Business School Suzhou, Xi'an Jiaotong-Liverpool University (USD 830). 2025
- Co-Principal Investigator and Primary Supervisor**, Star Ratings to Star Earnings: Impact of Reviews and Awards on Restaurant Dynamics; led and supervised undergraduate students under the SURF programme (SURF-2024-0266), Department of Economics, International Business School Suzhou, Xi'an Jiaotong-Liverpool University (USD 830). 2024
- Co-Principal Investigator and Primary Supervisor**, Research on the Spatial Pattern of Key Rural Tourism Destinations in China; led and supervised undergraduate students under the SURF programme (SURF-2023-0112), Department of Economics, International Business School Suzhou, Xi'an Jiaotong-Liverpool University (USD 830). 2023
- Research Team Member**, The Study on the Non-grain Land Transfer Problem in the Main Grain Producing Areas in China, National Social Science Fund of China, Grant No. 14BJY108. 2017–2019

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

- Dissertation Supervision**, Department of Economics, International Business School Suzhou, Xi'an Jiaotong-Liverpool University. Supervised undergraduate dissertation projects, providing guidance on research design, data analysis, and academic writing, with an emphasis on independent research skills and empirical methods.
- Final Year Undergraduate Program. 2024–2025
- Teaching (approximately 900 hours)**, Department of Economics, International Business School Suzhou, Xi'an Jiaotong-Liverpool University. Responsible for delivering formal undergraduate tutorial sessions in English Language, each lasting one hour, to classes of approximately 20 students, including lecturing core material, guiding problem-solving exercises, and addressing students' questions in an interactive setting.
- Economics Principles for Business and Markets, Undergraduate-level courses. AY2023–AY2024
 - Trends in Economics and Finance, Undergraduate-level course. AY2022–AY2023
 - Introduction to Statistics, Undergraduate-level course. AY2022–AY2023
 - Introduction to Business and Economics, Undergraduate-level course. AY2022–AY2023
 - Environmental Economics, Undergraduate-level course. AY2021–AY2022
 - Economic Principles for Business and Markets, Undergraduate-level course. AY2021–AY2022

ACTIVITIES AND AWARDS

- Chair**, PGR Student–Staff Liaison Committee (Voting Member), Xi'an Jiaotong-Liverpool University. 2022–2025
- PhD Representative**, Department of Economics, Xi'an Jiaotong-Liverpool University. 2022–2025
- First-Class Postgraduate Scholarship** (Top 5%), Heilongjiang University (USD 1,670). 2019
- Entrance Scholarship**, Heilongjiang University (USD 1,110). 2017

RESEARCH SKILLS

- Econometrics**: Stata and R.
- Machine Learning & NLP**: Python.
- Spatial Analysis**: ArcGIS and R.

LANGUAGE

English: Fluent (academic writing and teaching). **Chinese (Mandarin)**: Native.